December 17, 2025

U.S. Department of Homeland Security
U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services
Regional Service Center

RE: Professional Recommendation for CA Shakeel Anwar Mohammed

To Whom It May Concern:

I am Sriram Panyam, a Technical Fellow at General Motors and a former Engineering Manager at Google, where I worked from August 2020 to March 2023. With over 20 years of experience in building large-scale software platforms at companies like Google, LinkedIn, and Amazon, my expertise lies in distributed systems and data processing. I am writing this letter to attest to the extraordinary abilities of Mr. Shakeel Anwar Mohammed (Mr. Mohammed), whose work I had the privilege of witnessing from the perspective of an internal stakeholder and customer during a critical period at Google.

During my tenure at Google, I led the engineering teams for Cloud Dataflow, a platform responsible for processing vast amounts of data, which included critical billing and security functions. In this capacity, my teams were direct internal consumers and stakeholders of the financial infrastructure that Mr. Mohammed was brought in to transform. We had a vested interest in the efficiency, accuracy, and security of the treasury systems, as any bottlenecks or errors in financial data processing would directly impact our platform's operational integrity and our ability to scale. It was through this lens that I observed Mr. Mohammed's work from April 2022 to August 2022.

Google's internal technology teams, including my own, operate at an exceptionally high standard. However, we recognized a critical gap in the specialized domain of SAP Financial Supply Chain Management (FSCM). When treasury operations faced significant challenges with bank account integration and hedge accounting compliance, it was clear that we needed a world-class expert. Mr. Mohammed's reputation for deep, niche expertise in this area preceded him. The decision to engage him was based on the understanding that his unique skills were indispensable for solving problems that were creating a ripple effect across multiple technology and business units, including my own.

Mr. Mohammed was engaged on the Google initiative through Deloitte, which was serving as one of Google's primary consulting partners for the program. Deloitte brought him into

the engagement specifically for his specialized expertise in SAP financial services, treasury systems, and accounting-driven system design capabilities that are not commonly available within standard consulting teams. When Mr. Mohammed was onboarded, The project was facing two significant crises that were causing operational gridlock and introducing unacceptable levels of risk for a company of Google's scale and complexity.

The Bank Account Management (BAM) Bottleneck

Google's treasury operations are vast, involving thousands of bank accounts across the globe. The process to integrate a single new bank account into their SAP system was taking a staggering four months. This was a major operational impediment. Every four-month delay meant lost agility. It hampered Google's ability to partner with new financial institutions, delayed the deployment of new products, and created a cascade of manual workarounds for the treasury team. The reconciliation process was a nightmare of spreadsheets and manual ticking-and-tying.[1] For a company that requires being able to operate at the speed of light, this was an anchor dragging down their entire treasury function.

Mr. Mohammed's first order of business was to diagnose the BAM workflow. He analyzed the entire end-to-end business process. He identified and proved that multiple approval steps were redundant and created a streamlined, optimized workflow.

By eliminating these bottlenecks, he slashed the bank account integration timeline from four months to just one month, that was a game-changer for Google. It enabled the treasury function to open bank accounts much faster to support new entities, product launches, and regulatory requirements across dozens of countries, rather than waiting for months and incurring delays, higher bank fees, and compliance exposure. This improvement directly strengthened Google's ability to manage global cash positions and financial risk and contributed to savings in avoidable bank charges. He then designed and built a fully automated reconciliation process for Institutional Cash Distributor (ICD) transactions, replacing an error-prone, spreadsheet-based manual workflow with a rules-driven, system-controlled solution that gave the treasury team real-time visibility into cash movements and eliminated hundreds of man-hours of clerical work each month.

[1] An accounting process for verifying the accuracy of financial statements by "ticking" individual figures to confirm they are correct and "tying" them to ensure they match across different documents. It's a form of reconciliation to ensure that numbers on a report, such as the balance sheet, agree with supporting schedules, the general ledger, and other source documents. This process identifies inconsistencies that indicate a potential error, such as a misstatement or omission.

What set him apart was not just automating tasks, but re-architecting the underlying process and accountability model, creating clear ownership, automated tracking and reminders, and simple, user-friendly documentation that employees across different regions could adopt quickly. This level of innovation, combining process design, system configuration, automation, and organizational change went well beyond typical SAP configuration work and required a strategic understanding of treasury operations, risk, and compliance, thus creating a transformative impact.

The Hedge Accounting Compliance Black Hole

As a global entity, Google deals with immense foreign currency exposure. The SAP FSCM Hedge Accounting module was intended to manage this risk, but it was not configured to meet the stringent requirements of US Generally Acceptable Accounting Practices (GAAP). An improperly configured hedge accounting system could lead to material misstatements[2] in Google's financial reports, attracting scrutiny from the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) and potentially requiring costly restatements. The complexity of cash flow hedges, forward contracts, and early de-designations was beyond the scope of a general SAP consultant.

Mr. Mohammed's prominent expertise in both SAP and US GAAP was immediately apparent because he didn't just start the hedge accounting functionality, he engineered it so that every short-term investment flowing through the system was automatically measured at fair value, with the unrealized gains and losses calculated and posted to the correct GAAP accounts without anyone having to touch a spreadsheet. In practice, this meant that when Google moved hundreds of millions of dollars into short-term instruments, the system could instantly calculate the market value change and reflect it in the financial statements, rather than relying on error-prone manual journal entries.

He then took on the most complex scenarios and personally led UAT for cash-flow hedges, forward foreign currency contracts, early de-designations, and treasury deal offsets, building real-life test scenarios that mimicked Google's global trading activity so the team could see how a hedge behaved when a currency moved, a contract expired early, or two trades collided. These tests proved that the system could handle extreme edge cases

[2] A misstatement is an error or inaccuracy in financial reporting, which is the difference between what is reported and what is required by accounting standards. These can occur due to unintentional mistakes, intentional fraud, or unreasonable judgment, and they can include errors in data, omissions, incorrect classifications, or improper disclosures. A misstatement can impact a company's financial position, and if it is significant enough, it is called a *material misstatement* because it could influence a user's decision-making.

without breaking, which meant forecasts, income statements, and regulatory reports would stay accurate under stress.

By doing this, he single-handedly mitigated a major financial reporting risk for one of the world's largest companies, before his work, a single mis-valued trade or incorrect hedge reclassification could swing earnings by millions and trigger an audit escalation, after his work, the system performed these calculations automatically, accurately, and consistently, giving Google's treasury and controllership leadership confidence that their numbers were correct the first time and every time.

It is uncommon to find a consultant with Mr. Mohammed's unique blend of strategic insight, technical mastery, and proven impact. He was brought into a high-stakes environment at Google to solve problems that were impeding the operations of a global tech giant, and he delivered solutions that were transformative.

Mr. Mohammed had authored a 36-page paper, "Optimizing Financial Management with SAP FSCM Treasury and Risk Management Solutions," published in a high impact factor international Journal.[3] Seeing him reduce the Google BAM timeline was like watching his academic research come to life. He was implementing the very optimization principles he had written about, proving their real-world value.

His status as a leader in this field was further cemented by a feature in the IB Times in October 2023.[4] The article, focused on his innovations, showcased his expertise to a global audience. This public recognition is a clear indicator of his standing in the field.

This pattern of sustained acclaim from peer-reviewed research and media coverage is what sets him apart. It demonstrates a career built on a foundation of deep, evolving, and consistently recognized expertise.

His work is evidence-based, his impact is quantifiable, and his reputation is backed by a consistent record of sustained acclaim. The fact that Deloitte, with its vast resources,

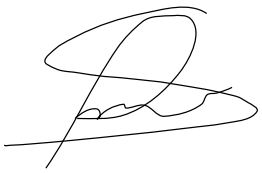
[3] https://isjr.co.in/index.php/ISJR/article/view/364

[4] https://www.ibtimes.sg/empowering-financial-institutions-shakeel-anwar-mohammeds-innovations-banking-insurance-77031#google_vignette

specifically sought out and named him on a contract for a client as critical as Google is perhaps the strongest testament to his indispensable role in this field.

I recommend him without any reservation and with the highest degree of professional confidence.

Regards,



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